Salesforce Certified Tableau Data Analyst - Challenging Practice Exam

Exam code simulated: Analytics-DA-201 | **Format:** 60 knowledge-based questions

Item	Detail
Questions	**60** (mirrors the scored knowledge items)
Time allowed	**105 minutes** (~105 seconds per question)
Passing target	**65% -> 39 / 60 correct**
Question types	Multiple choice (1 answer), Multiple selection (**SELECT 2 / SELECT 3**), and Build list (order the steps)
Scoring	**No partial credit** - a multi-select or build-list item is correct only when *every* part is exact
Materials	Closed book. You may flag and revisit questions; there is no penalty for guessing

> **Focus areas (your requested emphasis):** Level of Detail (LOD) expressions, calculated fields (date / string / logical / number / type-conversion / aggregate), table calculations, and multiple-selection items. Domain 2 is deliberately loaded with these topics because it is also the heaviest section of the real exam (41%).

Domain map of this paper

Domain	Official weight	Questions	Question count
1. Connect to & Transform Data	24%	Q1-Q14	14
2. Explore & Analyze Data	41%	Q15-Q41	27
3. Create Content	26%	Q42-Q55	14
4. Publish & Manage Content (Server / Cloud)	9%	Q56-Q60	5
Total	**100%**		**60**

Section 1 - Connect to and Transform Data (Q1-Q14)

Q1. A logistics company must monitor warehouse stock levels that the database itself updates every minute. The dashboard must always reflect the database's current state with no delay. Which connection type should you use?

- A. An extract refreshed every 15 minutes
- B. A live connection to the database
- C. An extract with incremental refresh enabled
- D. A data blend between two extracts

Q2. An analyst's workbook connects live to a slow cloud data warehouse. Every filter change takes minutes to redraw. The underlying data is reloaded only once per day at 2:00 AM. Which approach best improves dashboard performance while keeping the data current enough?

- A. Keep the live connection and add more context filters
- B. Replace the source with an extract and schedule a refresh shortly after the nightly load

- C. Convert every worksheet to custom SQL
- D. Replace the join with a data blend

Q3. [SELECT 2] Which TWO are genuine advantages of using an extract instead of a live connection?

- A. Queries run faster because the data is stored in Tableau's columnar Hyper engine
- B. The dashboard always shows the source database's real-time values
- C. The workbook can be opened and used offline and is portable to other machines
- D. The extract never needs to be refreshed

Q4. A workbook is built on an old Excel file. A new, identically structured CSV must now feed every worksheet that used the Excel file. The field names match. What should you do so that existing charts keep working?

- A. Manually re-add each field to every sheet
- B. Use **Data -> Replace Data Source...** to point the workbook at the new file
- C. Create a union between the Excel and CSV files
- D. Duplicate the workbook and rebuild the views

Q5. You combine an **Orders** table (many rows per customer, transaction level) with a **Customers** table (exactly one row per customer, current segment and region). You want Tableau to preserve each table's native granularity, avoid duplicating customer rows, and let the model query at either level. Which method should you use?

- A. An inner join on Customer ID
- B. A relationship between the two tables
- C. A data blend with Customers as the secondary source
- D. A union of the two tables

Q6. You must combine an **Orders** table with a **Returns** table so that **every** order appears in the result, including orders that have no matching return row (those return fields should be blank). Which join type should you use with Orders as the left table?

- A. Inner join
- B. Left join
- C. Right join
- D. Full outer join

Q7. A spreadsheet stores monthly revenue as twelve separate columns named `Jan`, `Feb`, ... `Dec`. You want a tidy table with a `Month` column and a single `Revenue` column so you can chart the trend over time. Which operation should you perform?

- A. Split the Month field
- B. Pivot the twelve columns into rows
- C. Union the twelve columns
- D. Apply the Data Interpreter

Q8. You have five CSV files from five regional offices. Each file has exactly the same columns and structure, and you want to stack all of the rows into one table. Which operation should you use?

- A. Union
- B. Join
- C. Relationship
- D. Blend

Q9. When you create an extract, you want to limit the rows that are physically written into the extract file (for example, only the last three years of orders). Which filter type should you use?

- A. A context filter on the worksheet
- B. A table-calculation filter

- C. An extract filter defined on the extract
- D. A quick filter shown on a single sheet

Q10. You want one filter that is defined once, applies to every worksheet and every user of the data source, and is applied when Tableau queries the database. Which filter type should you use?

- A. A data source filter
- B. A context filter on one worksheet
- C. A Top N filter on a single sheet
- D. A relative-date quick filter

Q11. A Tableau Prep flow cleans and combines data for a downstream application that does **not** have Tableau and needs a plain, universally readable file. Which output type should the flow produce?

- A. A `.hyper` extract
- B. A `.csv` file
- C. A packaged workbook (`.twbx`)
- D. A `.tfl` flow file

Q12. In Tableau Prep, a `Name` column contains these four values:
`Oliver, Inthavong` - `Oliver Inthavong` - `OliverInthavong` - `Oliver: Inthavong`.
You want Tableau Prep to automatically group all four as the same value because they contain the **same characters regardless of order and separators**. Which Group Values option should you use?

- A. Manual Selection
- B. Spelling
- C. Pronunciation
- D. Common Characters

Q13. An Excel file has a title row above the headers, merged header cells, a subtotal row in the middle, and a footnote at the bottom. Tableau cannot read the sheet cleanly. Which built-in feature removes this extraneous information automatically?

- A. Wildcard union
- B. Data Interpreter
- C. Data source filter
- D. Pivot

Q14. In a data source, the field `Customer ID` currently appears as a green measure and is being summed when used. You want each Customer ID listed individually as a category on the Rows shelf. What should you do?

- A. Change the aggregation from SUM to COUNTD
- B. Convert the field from a measure to a dimension
- C. Wrap it in an LOD expression
- D. Change the number format to text

Section 2 - Explore and Analyze Data (Q15-Q41)

LOD expressions

Q15. In a view of `SUM(Sales)` by Sub-Category, you want each bar to show that sub-category's share of **total** sales. Crucially, the denominator must remain the grand total even after a user filters out a sub-category with a normal dimension filter. Which calculation should you use?

- A. `SUM([Sales]) / TOTAL(SUM([Sales]))`

- B. `SUM([Sales]) / SUM({FIXED : SUM([Sales])})`
- C. `SUM([Sales]) / SUM({INCLUDE [Sub-Category] : SUM([Sales])})`
- D. `SUM([Sales]) / SUM({EXCLUDE [Sub-Category] : SUM([Sales])})`

Q16. A view shows `SUM(Sales)` by Region. In the same view you also want to show the **average sales per customer** for each region. Which calculation, placed on a second axis and aggregated as AVG, produces the correct result?

- A. `{FIXED [Region] : AVG([Sales])}`
- B. `{INCLUDE [Customer Name] : SUM([Sales])}`
- C. `{EXCLUDE [Region] : SUM([Sales])}`
- D. `AVG([Sales])`

Q17. A view breaks out `SUM(Sales)` by **Region** and by **Month**. You want to shade the marks by total sales for each month **across all regions** (removing the region split). Which calculation should you use?

- A. `{EXCLUDE [Region] : SUM([Sales])}`
- B. `{EXCLUDE [Month] : SUM([Sales])}`
- C. `{FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])}`
- D. `{INCLUDE [Month] : SUM([Sales])}`

Q18. With `Order Date (Month/Year)` on Columns, you want to show the difference between each month's actual sales and the **average monthly sales across the entire four-year period**. Which calculation produces this measure?

- A. `{EXCLUDE [Order Date (Month/Year)] : AVG({FIXED [Order Date (Month/Year)] : SUM([Sales])})}`
- B. `{FIXED [Order Date (Month/Year)] : SUM([Sales])} - AVG([Sales])`
- C. `{INCLUDE [Order Date (Month/Year)] : AVG([Sales])}`
- D. `{FIXED : AVG([Sales])}`

Q19. You build a percent-of-total calculation whose denominator is `{FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])}`. When a user excludes some states with an ordinary dimension filter, the denominator does **not** change. Why?

- A. FIXED LOD expressions are evaluated before dimension filters are applied
- B. FIXED LOD expressions are table calculations that run last
- C. Dimension filters never affect any calculation in Tableau
- D. The denominator is a string, so the filter cannot change it

Q20. Which statement correctly distinguishes a **FIXED** LOD from an **INCLUDE** LOD?

- A. FIXED respects every dimension in the view; INCLUDE ignores all view dimensions
- B. FIXED computes using only the dimensions declared in the expression and ignores the view's dimensions; INCLUDE computes using the declared dimensions *in addition to* the view's dimensions
- C. Both behave identically; only the syntax differs
- D. INCLUDE can be used only with measures, while FIXED can be used only with dimensions

Q21. Which LOD keyword adds a dimension that is **not present in the view** to the calculation's level of detail?

- A. FIXED
- B. INCLUDE
- C. EXCLUDE
- D. TOTAL

Q22. You want the **total number of distinct customers in each Region** to appear on every row belonging to that region, even when `Sub-Category` is also in the view. Which calculation is correct?

- A. `{FIXED [Region] : COUNTD([Customer ID])}`

- B. `{INCLUDE [Region] : COUNTD([Customer ID])}`
- C. `{EXCLUDE [Region] : COUNTD([Customer ID])}`
- D. `COUNTD([Customer ID])`

Q23. [SELECT 2] Which TWO statements about LOD expressions and filters are true?

- A. FIXED LOD expressions are affected by context filters, data source filters, and extract filters
- B. FIXED LOD expressions are affected by ordinary dimension filters
- C. INCLUDE and EXCLUDE LOD expressions are affected by dimension filters
- D. LOD expressions are table calculations and therefore run after everything else

Q24. You write `{ FIXED [Region] : MIN([Order Date]) }`. When you save it, how does Tableau classify the resulting field?

- A. Always a measure
- B. A dimension, because the underlying aggregate `MIN([Order Date])` is a date dimension
- C. Always a string
- D. A table calculation

Calculated fields

Q25. A text field `[Order Date Text]` contains values such as `2024-03-15`. You need to convert it into a true date value. Which function should you use?

- A. `DATE("2024-03-15")`
- B. `DATEPARSE("yyyy-MM-dd", [Order Date Text])`
- C. `MAKEDATE([Order Date Text])`
- D. `DATEADD('day', 0, [Order Date Text])`

Q26. You need the number of days that elapsed between `[Order Date]` and `[Ship Date]`. Which calculation should you use?

- A. `DATEDIFF('day', [Order Date], [Ship Date])`
- B. `DATENAME('day', [Ship Date]) - DATENAME('day', [Order Date])`
- C. `DATETRUNC('day', [Ship Date])`
- D. `DATEADD('day', [Order Date], [Ship Date])`

Q27. A field `[Customer Name]` stores values like `"Smith, John"`. You want a new field that contains only the first name (`"John"`) with no leading space. Which calculation is best?

- A. `TRIM(SPLIT([Customer Name], ",", 2))`
- B. `LEFT([Customer Name], 5)`
- C. `MID([Customer Name], 1, 4)`
- D. `RIGHT([Customer Name], 1)`

Q28. You want to replace every occurrence of `"Inc."` in `[Company]` with `"Incorporated"`. Which string function should you use?

- A. `REPLACE([Company], "Inc.", "Incorporated")`
- B. `FIND([Company], "Inc.")`
- C. `CONTAINS([Company], "Inc.")`
- D. `SPLIT([Company], "Inc.", 1)`

Q29. You want to classify each row by profit: if `[Profit]` is below 0, return `"Loss"`; if exactly 0, return `"Break-even"`; otherwise return `"Profit"`. Which calculation is correct?

- A. `IF [Profit] < 0 THEN "Loss" ELSEIF [Profit] = 0 THEN "Break-even" ELSE "Profit" END`
- B. `IF [Profit] < 0 OR [Profit] = 0 THEN "Loss" ELSE "Profit" END`

- C. `CASE [Profit] WHEN "Loss" THEN 0 ELSE 1 END`
- D. `IIF([Profit] > 0, "Loss", "Profit")`

Q30. Which calculation returns `TRUE` only when `[Sales]` is greater than 1,000 **and** the `[Region]` equals `"West"`?

- A. `IF [Sales] > 1000 AND [Region] = "West" THEN "Yes" ELSE "No" END`
- B. `IF [Sales] > 1000 OR [Region] = "West" THEN "Yes" ELSE "No" END`
- C. `IF [Sales] > 1000 THEN IF [Region] = "West" THEN "No" ELSE "Yes" END END`
- D. `CASE [Region] WHEN "West" THEN "Yes" ELSE "No" END`

Q31. You want to display the average discount rounded to **one decimal place**. Which calculation is correct?

- A. `ROUND(AVG([Discount]), 1)`
- B. `ROUND(AVG([Discount]), 0)`
- C. `AVG(ROUND([Discount], 0))`
- D. `INT(AVG([Discount]))`

Q32. A CSV imports `[Store Number]` as a **string**, but you need it as a whole number for a numeric calculation. Which function should you use?

- A. `STR([Store Number])`
- B. `INT([Store Number])`
- C. `DATE([Store Number])`
- D. `SPLIT([Store Number])`

Q33. You want the number of **unique customers** who purchased in each region. Which aggregate function should you use on `[Customer ID]`?

- A. `SUM([Customer ID])`
- B. `COUNT([Customer ID])`
- C. `COUNTD([Customer ID])`
- D. `ATTR([Customer ID])`

Table calculations

Q34. Monthly sales are on Columns. You want a **3-period moving average** that includes the current month and the two prior months. Which calculation should you use?

- A. `WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0)`
- B. `WINDOW_SUM(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0)`
- C. `RUNNING_SUM(SUM([Sales])) / 3`
- D. `AVG([Sales])`

Q35. You want a **year-to-date running total** of sales that resets at the start of each new year. Which approach is correct?

- A. Use `RUNNING_SUM(SUM([Sales]))`, addressed along Month and partitioned by Year, so the total restarts each year
- B. Use `TOTAL(SUM([Sales]))`
- C. Use `WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales]), -11, 0)`
- D. Use `LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1)`

Q36. You want the **percent difference** in sales from the previous month. Which calculation should you use?

- A. `(SUM([Sales]) - LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1)) / LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1)`
- B. `SUM([Sales]) - LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1)`
- C. `SUM([Sales]) / TOTAL(SUM([Sales]))`

- D. `RANK(SUM([Sales]))`

Q37. Which table calculation returns the row's **position within its partition, starting at 1**?

- A. `INDEX()`
- B. `RANK(SUM([Sales]))`
- C. `FIRST()`
- D. `LAST()`

Q38. You have the first-period value in `[First Value]`, the last-period value in `[Last Value]`, and `n` periods. Which formula computes the **compound growth rate per period**?

- A. `POWER([Last Value] / [First Value], 1 / ([n] - 1)) - 1`
- B. `([Last Value] - [First Value]) / [First Value]`
- C. `([Last Value] + [First Value]) / [n]`
- D. `POWER(([Last Value] - [First Value]) / [First Value], [n] - 1)`

Filters, parameters, sets, and bins

Q39. A worksheet has a general dimension filter on `City` and a Top 10 filter on `Customer Name`. The Top 10 is being computed across all cities instead of within the chosen city. How do you fix the order of operations?

- A. Add the `City` filter to context so it runs before the Top 10 filter
- B. Change the Top 10 filter to a Bottom 10 filter
- C. Convert both filters to table-calculation filters
- D. Remove the `City` filter and use a parameter instead

Q40. You want users to type a numeric target into a control, and a reference line on the chart should move to that value. Which feature should you use?

- A. A parameter inserted into the reference line's value
- B. A quick table calculation
- C. A wildcard filter
- D. A set action

Q41. You want to build a **histogram** of customer ages. Which feature is required?

- A. A set on the `Age` field
- B. A group on the `Age` field
- C. A bin created from the continuous `Age` measure
- D. A hierarchy containing `Age`

Section 3 - Create Content (Q42-Q55)

Q42. You want one view that shows `SUM(Sales)` as bars and `Profit Ratio` as a line, each on its **own independent axis** with its own scale. What should you do?

- A. Drag the second measure next to the first on the Rows shelf, then right-click the axis and select **Dual Axis**
- B. Place both measures on the same axis and change their colors
- C. Put one measure on Rows and one on the Filters shelf
- D. Create two separate worksheets and place them side by side

Q43. You want a scatter plot showing the relationship between `Sales` and `Profit` at the **customer** level, with points colored by `Profit Ratio`. How should you build it?

- A. Sales on Columns, Profit on Rows, `Customer Name` on Detail, `Profit Ratio` on Color

- B. Sales on Columns, Profit on Rows, `Profit Ratio` on Size only
- C. `Customer Name` on Columns, Sales on Rows
- D. Sales on Color, Profit on Size, `Profit Ratio` on Rows

Q44. Which configuration correctly builds a **histogram**?

- A. Put a continuous measure on Columns and a dimension on Rows
- B. Create a bin from a continuous measure, place the bin on Columns, and a `COUNT` of rows (or the measure) on Rows
- C. Put two measures on the same axis and select Dual Axis
- D. Use a treemap with the measure on Size

Q45. You want to show profit by product category as **nested rectangles whose area represents sales**. Which chart type should you use?

- A. Highlight table
- B. Treemap
- C. Gantt chart
- D. Box plot

Q46. You want to display each project task as a **horizontal bar spanning its start and end dates**. Which chart type should you use?

- A. Gantt chart (a dimension on Rows, a continuous date on Columns, and a duration field on Size)
- B. Histogram
- C. Scatter plot
- D. Symbol map

Q47. Users want the product categories listed in a **specific business order** (not alphabetical and not by a measure). Which feature should you use?

- A. A manual (custom) sort order applied to the dimension
- B. A quick table calculation
- C. A wildcard filter
- D. A set action

Q48. [SELECT 2] Which TWO statements about dashboard **layout containers** are correct?

- A. A fixed-size container keeps its dimensions when the dashboard is resized
- B. A layout container can hold other containers, sheets, and objects such as text and images
- C. Containers can hold only a single worksheet
- D. Tiled and floating layouts cannot be mixed in one dashboard

Q49. On a dashboard, clicking a region in one map should **filter** the other worksheets on the dashboard. Which feature should you use?

- A. A filter action (Dashboard -> Actions -> Add Filter Action)
- B. A highlight action
- C. A URL action
- D. A tooltip

Q50. When a user clicks a store on a map, a web page should open with the store's ID appended to the URL. Which feature should you use?

- A. A URL action, inserting the store field into the URL
- B. A filter action
- C. Viz in Tooltip
- D. A data source filter

Q51. You want each mark a user selects to write a value into a parameter (or a set) that then drives highlighting elsewhere on the dashboard. Which feature should you use?

- A. Parameter action or set action
- B. Extract filter
- C. Data Interpreter
- D. Dual-axis synchronization

Q52. You want a dashboard zone to **appear or disappear automatically** based on a Boolean expression or a parameter - without the viewer clicking any button. Which feature should you use?

- A. Dynamic zone visibility
- B. A show/hide button
- C. A navigation button
- D. A subscription

Q53. You want the **viewer** to be able to click a control to toggle a dashboard object on and off. Which feature should you use?

- A. A show/hide button
- B. Dynamic zone visibility driven by a calculation
- C. A URL action
- D. A reference line

Q54. You want a small, detailed chart to appear when a user **hovers over a mark**. Which feature should you use?

- A. Viz in Tooltip
- B. A reference band
- C. A box plot
- D. A forecast

Q55. You need to add a company-specific **custom color palette** to Tableau Desktop. Where must the palette be defined?

- A. In the `Preferences.tps` file in the **My Tableau Repository**
- B. In the workbook's `.twb` XML file only
- C. In the data source's connection properties
- D. In the dashboard's layout settings

Section 4 - Publish and Manage Content (Q56-Q60)

Q56. Several workbooks across the company must all use the **same governed, cleaned dataset with a single definition**. What should you publish so others can connect to it?

- A. Each workbook with its own embedded copy of the data
- B. A published data source from Tableau Desktop or Tableau Prep
- C. A story containing all the sheets
- D. A screenshot of the data

Q57. To schedule an automatic **extract refresh** of a published data source on Tableau Server / Cloud, which condition must be true?

- A. The data source must use a live connection
- B. The data source must contain an extract
- C. The data source must be smaller than 1 GB

- D. Only a site administrator may create any refresh schedule

Q58. Which statement correctly distinguishes **alerts** from **subscriptions**?

- A. Alerts email a snapshot image on a schedule; subscriptions notify when a metric crosses a threshold
- B. Alerts notify when a metric crosses a threshold; subscriptions email a scheduled snapshot of a view or workbook
- C. Both require the user to have a Creator role
- D. Both require live connections

Q59. A user must be able to connect to new data sources, build content in web authoring, and **publish flows**. Which site role is required?

- A. Viewer
- B. Explorer
- C. Creator
- D. Viewer (can publish)

Q60. A viewer wants to save **their own filtered and sorted version** of a published view without changing the workbook for everyone else. What should they do?

- A. Duplicate the entire workbook
- B. Create and save a Custom View
- C. Edit the data source filter
- D. Ask an admin to revert the workbook

End of exam - 60 questions. Check your answers against `deepseek-answers.pdf` *(do not open it until you have finished the paper).*